

Ahmet Akbiyik

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WORK
EXPERIENCE

Quantitative UX Researcher, Meta, CA, US, 2025-Present

- Led projects within the Monetization team that informed product strategy by translating customer insights into system improvements. Conducted experiments to guide high-stakes investment decisions.
- Built an AI-supported pipeline (unmoderated interviews + AI-assisted analysis) that takes hypotheses to product decisions in days rather than weeks.

Co-founder, Galata Survey Research, Turkey, 2023-2025

- Built and led the engineering and research teams to develop a survey platform and participant pool.
- Enhanced survey methodologies through innovative experimental designs and randomization strategies, improving data reliability and enabling precise audience targeting.

Survey Consultant, Internews, UK, 2021-2023

- Designed and conducted surveys and focus groups for media outlet audiences to enhance product strategies and audience engagement.

EDUCATION

Harvard University, Cambridge, US

Ph.D., Political Economy and Government

Designed and executed large-scale panel experiments on intergroup dynamics and misinformation to develop policies for healthier online behavior.

Boston University, Boston, US

M.A., Political Science (started as a PhD student, transferred to Harvard)

Bogazici University, Istanbul, Turkey

B.A., Economics and Political Science (Double major)

Robert College, Istanbul, Turkey

American High School

PUBLISHED

[Social Media Narratives across Platforms in Conflict: Evidence from Syria](#) (with Erin Walk, Elizabeth Parker-Magyar, Kiran Garimella, Fotini Christia). *Journal of Politics*.

PREPRINTS

[Aiding Harmony: How International Aid Shapes Local Policy Preferences and Behavior toward Refugees](#) (with Melani Cammett)

[How Populist Incumbents Use Strategic Communication to Survive Economic Crises: The Surprising Effectiveness of Incumbent Economic Appeals](#) (with Andrew O'Donohue)

[Language-Agnostic Bias Detection in Language Models with Bias Probing](#) (with Abdullatif Köksal, Omer Faruk Yalcin, M. Tahir Kilavuz, Anna Korhonen, Hinrich Schütze). *EMNLP*. Preprint.

[How Does Exposure to Discordant Media Sources Affect Political Attitudes and Behavior? Experimental Evidence from Turkey](#) (with Jeremy Bowles, Horacio Larreguy, Shelley Lui)

WORK IN
PROGRESS

Debunking Misinformation to Foster Inclusion of Refugees: A Comprehensive Approach towards Integration and Empowerment

Unpacking the Empathy-Altruism Hypothesis The effects of immersive virtual reality on attitudes and behaviors towards refugees in Jordan, Turkey, and Sweden

SKILLS

Methodological Specialization: survey and experimental methods, interviews (AI Pods)

Software: L^AT_EX, R, Python, SQL, Qualtrics

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE	Harvard University, MA, US
	<i>as Teaching Assistant</i>
	Evaluating the Impacts of Public Policies: How to Design and Implement Randomized Controlled Trials (by Michael Hiscox)
	Data (by Matt Blackwell)
	Survey Research Methods (by Chase Harrison)
	International and Global Affairs (by Matthew Bunn)
	<i>as Academic Workshop Coordinator</i>
	Comparative Politics Speakers Series Coordinator
	Boston University, MA, US
	<i>as Teaching Assistant</i>
GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS	Quantitative Research Methods (by Taylor Boas)
	The Harvard Merit/Term-time Research Fellowship, \$20,415
	JPAL Governance Initiative, \$49,170
	The Weatherhead Center Dissertation Writing Grant, \$20,415
	The Weatherhead Research Cluster on Migration Doctoral Fellows Program, \$7,000
	JPAL Governance Initiative w/ Horacio Larreguy, Jeremy Bowles, Shelley Lui, \$58,765
	The Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy, \$5,000
	Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grants, \$5,000
	GSAS Division of Social Sciences Fund, \$2,000
	Dean’s Fellowship, Boston University